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Lakshana-artha (non-literal word-meaning): Indian philosophers of language thought that words may have different sorts of significances, according to the context of use. The literal sense (*abhidha*, *mukhya-artha*) is innate in a word and is usually directly understood. But sometimes it is apparent that the literal meaning of a word is impossible in the context and we have to assume a non-literal meaning. We cannot substitute any meaning. We have to be able to justify the adoption of a non-literal meaning. There must be some relationship between the primary and secondary significances. For instance: 'Give food to the staff-holders' means 'Give food to the Brahmins' because Brahmins always carry staffs. In 'The village on the Ganges', the word 'Ganges' must be taken in the secondary sense of 'bank of the Ganges' because villages do not float. 'The umbrellas are coming' means that people with umbrellas are coming.

Later writers say that there are three types of non-literal word-meanings:

1. *Jahallakshana* (total secondary predication). 'There is a village on the Ganges', where the primary sense of 'Ganges' disappears and is replaced by 'bank of the Ganges'.
2. *Ajahallakshana* (retention of the primary sense plus adoption of a secondary sense). For example, 'The spears are coming', where 'spear' refers to both spears and their carriers.
3. *Jahadajahallakshana* (partial secondary predication): 'The man is a lion'. Such properties as ferocity and so on that he shares with the lion are attributed to the